



A Starbound Modlist Guide

Starbound 1.4.4 · v1.0

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About This Guide

Welcome to **Aetherbound**, a curated modlist guide for Starbound 1.4.4, built around Frackin Universe and OpenStarbound.

What This Is

Aetherbound is a single, cohesive modlist — 57 mods spanning quality-of-life, bugfixes, graphics, new races, expanded content, and deeper mechanics. Every mod has been verified for compatibility with Starbound 1.4.4, Frackin Universe, and OpenStarbound.

WARNING **Frackin Universe is a one-way trip.** Installing FU permanently alters your game universe and ALL characters. Uninstalling FU will cause crashes. This is not a “try it and see” mod — once you install it, you are committed. Make a full backup of your storage folder before starting.

How It Works

The guide has two prose chapters and a comprehensive modlist:

- **Getting Started** — a primer for players new to Starbound or new to Frackin Universe. Covers the FU-era basics.
- **Strategy** — advanced tips for experienced protectors: planet farming, crew synergies, mech tactics, and modded system deep-dives.
- **Modlist** — 57 mods organized into 10 categories. Each mod entry includes a verified Workshop link, dependencies, and SBMM install notes.

Mod Selection Philosophy

Every mod in Aetherbound passes a strict filter:

- **Compatible:** Works with Starbound 1.4.x and OpenStarbound. No exceptions.
- **Non-cheating:** No god-mode items, free resources, or all-knowing UI panels.
- **Non-redundant:** When two mods do the same thing, we pick the better one.
- **Non-conflicting:** No mod pair breaks each other. Documented when unavoidable.
- **Appropriate:** Adult content is tasteful and relevant. No porn.

TIP Each mod entry includes a clickable Steam Workshop link, dependency list, and SBMM-specific install notes. You are expected to install mods yourself — this guide tells you what to get and how to set it up.

Prerequisites

Before you begin:

- Starbound 1.4.4 installed via Steam
- OpenStarbound — download from github.com/OpenStarbound
- SBMM (Starbound Mod Manager) by korsir — download from GitHub
- About 45 minutes for initial setup

Installation Guide

This chapter walks you through setting up OpenStarbound, SBMM (Starbound Mod Manager), preparing your game, and installing mods.

Step 1: Install OpenStarbound

OpenStarbound is a required fork of the Starbound engine. It fixes bugs, improves performance, and enables Lua scripting that many mods in this list require.

Download the latest stable release from github.com/OpenStarbound/OpenStarbound.

CONCEPT OpenStarbound is **not** a mod — it is a separate executable. Think of it like SKSE for Skyrim: a drop-in replacement that runs the same game but extends what mods can do.

Windows Setup

1. Run the OpenStarbound installer or extract the client zip to a folder of your choice (e.g., `C:\Games\OpenStarbound`).
2. Copy `packed.pak` from your Steam Starbound folder (usually `C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\steamapps\common\Starbound\assets\packed.pak`) to the OpenStarbound assets folder.
3. Optionally copy the user folder from your Steam Starbound folder to transfer instrument songs.
4. Launch `openstarbound.exe` — it will load your Steam Workshop mods if Steam is running.

TIP Create a desktop shortcut to `openstarbound.exe`. You will launch the game through this, not through Steam or the original `starbound.exe`.

Transferring Saves

Copy your `storage` folder from the Steam Starbound folder to the OpenStarbound folder to transfer characters, ships, and universe data. If you have locally installed (non-Steam) mods, copy the `mods` folder as well.

Step 2: Install SBMM

SBMM (Starbound Mod Manager) by **korsir** handles mod profiles, load order, conflict detection, and Workshop integration.

Download SBMM from its GitHub repository: [SBMM on GitHub](#)

Extract the archive to a folder of your choice (e.g., C:\Tools\SBMM). Run SBMM.exe to launch.

Step 3: Configure SBMM

First Launch

On first launch, SBMM will ask you to locate your Starbound installation. Point it to your OpenStarbound folder.

Create Profile

Create a single SBMM profile: **Aetherbound**

Set Up Mod Groups

Within the profile, create **groups** (folder-like categories) matching the modlist structure:

00-Foundations, 01-UI-QoL, 02-Graphics, 03-Audio, 04-Races, 05-Content, 06-Mechanics, 07-Ships, 08-Building, 09-Adult

Place mods into their corresponding group as you install them. This keeps your load order organized and makes troubleshooting easier.

Step 4: Workshop Backup Strategy

Steam Workshop auto-updates mods, which can break your carefully tested setup at any time. To prevent this:

1. Subscribe to all mods listed in this guide on Steam Workshop
2. Wait for Steam to download them (check the Downloads page)
3. Navigate to your Workshop content folder: Steam\steamapps\workshop\content\211820\
4. Copy the entire 211820 folder to a safe location (e.g., C:\StarboundMods\Aetherbound\)
5. In SBMM, configure the profile to use this **backup** folder — not the live Workshop folder

WARNING Always back up your Workshop mods before starting a playthrough. If a mod updates mid-game and breaks your save, you can restore from the backup. SBMM cannot roll back Workshop updates.

Your backup folder is a frozen snapshot of a known-good mod set.

Step 5: Install Mods

For each mod in the guide:

1. Click the mod name (it links to the Steam Workshop page)

2. Click **Subscribe** on the Workshop page
3. Wait for Steam to download it
4. In SBMM, refresh your mod list — the new mod should appear
5. Drag it into the correct group
6. Check the install notes in the mod entry for any special instructions

TIP Install mods in the order they appear within each category. This follows the recommended load order and minimizes conflicts.

Step 6: Verify Your Setup

Before starting a playthrough:

- In SBMM, run the conflict checker. Resolve any flagged conflicts (check `conflicts.md` for guidance).
- Launch OpenStarbound through SBMM (not directly through Steam).
- Start a new game. Confirm the main menu loads without errors.
- Complete the intro mission. Confirm no crashes or missing assets.

If something goes wrong, disable mods in groups (starting from the last group) until you identify the problem mod.

Getting Started

A new protector awakens

Frackin Universe is a one-way trip.
Your universe, your characters, your journey —
everything changes from this point forward.
Here is what you need to know.

Getting Started

Frackin Universe is vast. New biomes, research trees, automation, genetics, brewing, bees — it can overwhelm even veteran Starbound players. This primer gives you a map. Not a walkthrough, but a compass.

CONCEPT Your first goal is not to finish the story. It is to find your footing. FU rewards curiosity, not speed. Every system you explore, every crafting tier you unlock, every strange creature you extract genes from — these are the real milestones.

Keyboard Shortcuts

TIP These are OpenStarbound defaults. Open the keybind menu from Options to customize.

Movement & Interaction

Key	Action
W A S D	Move
Space	Jump (hold for jetpack / flight tech)
E	Interact (doors, NPCs, crafting stations, containers)
Shift	Walk / Slow-fall (hold)
Shift + Scroll	Change Matter Manipulator mining radius
Double-tap A or D	Dash (with Dash Tech unlocked)

Inventory & Crafting

Key	Action
I	Open / close inventory
J	Quests
C	Empty-hand crafting menu
L	Codex and collections
Q	Drop held item
Tab	Dismiss SAIL dialog
1-0	Hotbar slots
X	Cycle hotbar left

Key	Action
Z	Cycle hotbar right

Matter Manipulator

Key	Action
Left Click	Mine block / Chop tree (MM equipped)
Right Click	Place block (MM equipped)
N	Toggle scan mode
R	Cycle MM mode (configure via /binds)

Combat

Key	Action
Left Click	Attack (weapon equipped)
Right Click	Alt-fire / Block (shield)
Ctrl	Crouch (reduces hitbox, dodges some projectiles)

Your First 20 Minutes

You have completed the intro mission, spoken to Esther at the Outpost, and repaired your ship. The navigation console sits waiting. Here is exactly what to do.

Minute 0–5: Beam Down

1. Select your starter planet from the nav console. It will be a **Lush** world — blue-green, temperate, threat level **Low**.
2. Beam down. You appear on a random spot on the surface.
3. **Stop.** Look around. Find a relatively flat area with trees and, ideally, visible surface ore or a cave entrance.

TIP If you beam down in rough terrain (cliff edges, deep water, no trees), walk for 30 seconds in one direction. The starter planet is large and forgiving — you will find a good spot.

4. Do NOT wander far from your beam-down point yet. You need a reference to find your way back to the ship. Build a 10-block-tall pillar of dirt directly under your feet. You can see it from anywhere on the surface.

Minute 5–10: Gather Basics

Walk in expanding circles around your pillar. Gather:

- **Wood** — left-click trees with your Matter Manipulator. Target 80 logs.
- **Plant Fibre** — the tall grass-like plants on the surface. Target 50.
- **Stone** — mine the grey surface rocks or dig down a few blocks. Target 100.
- **Coal** — black speckled rock, often near the surface or in shallow caves. Grab every piece you see.
- **Vines** — hanging from cave ceilings. Grab them if you find a cave entrance. They craft into bandages.

TIP Hold Shift and scroll the mouse wheel to increase your MM mining radius to 3x3 or larger. This clears trees and surface rock much faster. Your energy recharges quickly on the surface.

Kill the small surface creatures you encounter with your starter weapon. They drop **Raw Steak** (cook it for health) and **Leather** (early armor). Avoid anything significantly larger than you — you have no armor yet.

Minute 10–15: Core Fragments

Core Fragments power your ship's FTL drive and are required to visit other planets. You need 20 for your first jump.

1. Find a cave entrance or dig a staircase downward at a 45-degree angle.
2. Place **torches** on the walls as you go. Craft them from coal and wood in your inventory (1 → craft).
3. Keep descending until the background darkens and you see orange-glowing rock. This is **Core Fragment ore**.
4. Mine every orange rock you find.

WARNING Caves are dark and dangerous. If you see the glow is too faint and you are running out of torches, turn back. Getting lost in the dark without torches is how first runs end. Surface light means safety.

Minute 15–20: Return and Craft

1. Return to the surface. Either climb back up your staircase or use the **Beam Up** button (top of screen) to return to your ship.
2. At your ship, open the crafting menu (c). Craft:
 - **Torches** (coal + wood) — at least 20 more
 - **Wooden Platform** (wood) — 50 platforms for future cave exploration
 - **Primitive Furnace** (stone + coal) — this smelts ore into bars
 - **Campfire** (wood + coal) — cook raw meat for better healing
3. Smelt your copper ore into **Copper Bars** at the furnace.
4. Craft **Copper Chestpiece** at the basic crafting menu — your first armor upgrade.

CONCEPT At 20 minutes, you should have: a surface marker pillar, 20+ core fragments, basic tools and torches, a functioning furnace and campfire on your ship, and a copper chestpiece. You are ready.

How to Fight

Combat in Starbound is fast and punishing at low levels. FU adds weapon combos, alt-fires, and environmental threats. Here is how to survive.

Weapon Types

One-handed melee — Fast swing speed, moderate damage. Pairs with a shield or dual-wield. Best for learning combat rhythm.

Two-handed melee — Slow, high damage. Wide arc. Good for crowd control but leaves you vulnerable between swings.

Spears — Long reach, directional thrust. Safest melee weapon for new players. Hit enemies before they reach you.

Ranged (pistol / rifle / shotgun / bow) — Damage at distance. Pistols fire fast with low damage. Rifles are slower but hit harder. Shotguns shred at point-blank. Bows are silent and craftable early.

Staffs — Cast spells or projectiles that consume energy. High burst potential but you are defenseless when energy is drained.

Shields — Hold **Right Click** to block. Reduces incoming damage. FU shields can **parry**: raise the shield just before an attack lands to stagger the enemy. Timing is tight but rewarding.

Combat Rhythm

1. **Start at range.** Open with a ranged weapon to soften enemies before they close distance. A few rifle shots or a bow volley can cut an enemy's health by half before melee starts.
2. **Move constantly.** Never stand still. Strafe with **A** and **D** while attacking. Most enemy projectiles track your position — lateral movement makes them miss.
3. **Attack in bursts.** Land 2-3 melee hits, then dash or jump away. Enemy attack patterns are predictable: they wind up, swing, pause. Hit them during the pause.
4. **Watch your energy.** Jumping, dashing, alt-fires, and staff spells all drain the green bar. If it hits zero, you cannot dash away. Manage it like a second health bar.

TIP The Dash Tech (unlocked early at the Outpost) is your most important survival tool. Double-tap **A** or **D** to dash through enemies and reposition. Dash has invincibility frames — you can dash **through** projectiles.

Healing

- **Bandages** — crafted from plant fibre + vines. Heals slowly over time. Craft a stack of 20 before any dungeon.
- **Salves** — upgraded bandages. Better healing, available once you unlock Chemistry research.
- **Cooked meat** — instant health, but limited. Kill surface creatures and cook their drops at a campfire.
- **Red Stim Packs** — fast burst healing. Found as loot or crafted later. Save these for bosses.

Fighting Specific Enemies

Small creatures (Poptop, nutmidge, etc.) — Low health, fast, swarm. Use a wide-swing two-handed weapon or shotgun. Do not chase them — let them come to you.

Humanoid NPCs (bandits, cultists) — They use weapons like you. Block with a shield or outrange them with a spear. Their aim is bad if you keep moving.

Large monsters (adult poptop, gleap, crasberry) — High health, telegraphed attacks. Bait their charge or slam, dash behind them, hit 2-3 times, repeat. Never trade hits — you will lose.

Bosses — Each has a pattern. Spend your first attempt learning it without trying to win. Count their attacks, learn the gaps, then execute on the second try.

Armor Matters

Armor in FU is not just defense — it provides **resistances**. Ice armor protects against cold. Heat armor protects against fire and radiation. Check a planet's hazards before beaming down and wear the corresponding armor set. Going to a **Scorched** world without fire resistance is suicide.

WARNING Armor has tiers. A tier-1 chestpiece on a tier-4 planet will get you killed in one hit. Upgrade your armor before advancing to higher-threat planets. The threat level on the nav console is not a suggestion.

Setting Goals

Starbound has no linear path after the intro. FU amplifies this. Here is a framework.

Short-Term Goals (first 5 hours)

- Upgrade your Matter Manipulator at least twice (copper → silver → gold bars at the Inventor's Table)
- Build a **Research Terminal** and begin unlocking nodes
- Craft a full set of tier-2 armor
- Visit at least three different planet types
- Establish a small farm (3-4 crops, a well, some fencing)

Medium-Term Goals (10-20 hours)

- Complete the first three story missions (Erchius Mining Facility, Floran Artifact, Hyloti Artifact)
- Unlock the **Gene Design Lab** and begin extracting creature traits
- Build your first mech at the Outpost mech station
- Recruit your first crew member
- Establish a proper base with storage, crafting stations, and a teleporter network

Long-Term Goals (endgame)

- Complete the main FU progression: all research trees, gene extraction, bee breeding
- Build a fully automated resource pipeline (extraction labs, sifters, centrifuges)
- Max out your ship and crew
- Defeat the Ruin
- Explore the FU-exclusive endgame biomes (**Strange Sea, Penumbra, Proto-World**)

TIP Set your own goals. FU adds farming, brewing, beekeeping, genetics, and archaeology. You can ignore the main story entirely and build a brewery empire on a lush moon. That is a valid playthrough.

Research System

The Research Terminal is FU's tech tree. You unlock it early by crafting the terminal at the Inventor's Table.

How It Works

1. Place a Research Terminal and interact with it.
2. The tree has multiple branches: **Geology, Biology, Engineering, Chemistry**, etc.
3. Each node costs **Research** — a resource generated passively by your Research Terminal and actively by feeding items into it.
4. Unlocked nodes grant access to new crafting recipes, stations, and abilities.

CONCEPT Feed everything into the Research Terminal. That tier-1 sword you replaced? Research it. Those 300 blocks of dirt? Research them. Every item has a research value. Nothing is wasted.

Priority Nodes

- **Geology → Smelting** — unlocks the Fission Furnace upgrades
- **Biology → Agriculture** — unlocks advanced farming
- **Engineering → Automation** — unlocks item networks and automated crafting
- **Chemistry → Pharmaceuticals** — unlocks healing items and stims

Survival in Frackin Universe

FU reworks survival mechanics significantly. Here is what changed.

Hunger

Food now has multiple stats: hunger fill, expiration time, and **bonus effects**. Cooked meals provide buffs — damage resistance, speed, jump height. Raw ingredients are emergency rations, not a diet.

TIP Build a **Kitchen Counter** early. It consolidates advanced cooking recipes. Campfires are for the first hour, not the first week.

Environmental Hazards

FU planets have environmental effects: radiation, extreme cold, toxic atmospheres, acid rain, and more. Armor now provides **resistance** to these effects. Check a planet's details in the navigation console before beaming down, and pack the right gear.

WARNING Do not beam to a **Strange Sea** or **Penumbra** planet without checking its hazards. These biomes can kill you in seconds if you lack the correct resistance.

Species & Roleplaying

Your species shapes your character's perspective, but FU is species-agnostic — any species can do anything. These hooks are starting points.

Vanilla Species

CONCEPT Human — You were a Protectorate cadet when Earth fell. You carry survivor's guilt and a stubborn belief that humanity's best days are ahead. The stars are not a refuge — they are a test.

CONCEPT Apex — A defector from the Miniknog regime. You escaped the experiment that was meant to perfect you, and now you see its shadow in every authority that promises order. Freedom means never letting anyone decide who you should be.

CONCEPT Avian — A grounded one who rejected Kluex's priesthood and walked away from the temples. You seek a faith that does not demand sacrifice. The universe is vast and empty — and that is exactly why it needs kindness.

CONCEPT Floran — A hunter who left the tribe to see what else is out there. You are curious, not cruel. You collect trophies because they remind you of stories, not because you need to prove anything. Your spear is for protection, not conquest.

CONCEPT Glitch — A self-aware unit who outgrew its programmed medieval identity. You still speak in feudal metaphors because they are comfortable, but you know you are more than your code. Your quest is to build a purpose that was not assigned.

CONCEPT Hylotl — An artist and scholar exiled for challenging the isolationist orthodoxy. Beauty is not something to be hoarded — it is something to be shared. You travel not to escape, but to find new canvases.

CONCEPT Novakid — A living star who has forgotten everything before the flash. You do not remember your name, your home, or your past. You wear the brand because it is the only thing that feels like yours. The frontier calls because it is the only place that makes sense.

Modded Species

CONCEPT Avali — A pack-survivor from a world of ice and thin atmosphere. Your people are pragmatic, communal, and fiercely loyal to the pack. You left Avalon to prove that the pack is not a cage — it is the launchpad for something greater. You see the galaxy through aerogel-filtered lenses and find beauty in the cold.

CONCEPT Trink (Elithian) — A diplomat and trader from the Elithian Alliance. Your people believe in negotiation, in finding common ground across species. You carry trade pacts instead of grudges and see every alien culture as a potential partner.

CONCEPT Aegi (Elithian) — A warrior-philosopher who believes peace is something you fight for, not something you wish for. Your species values martial discipline as highly as intellectual rigor. You protect the weak not out of pity, but because strength without purpose is just violence.

CONCEPT Akkimari (Elithian) — A nomad and storyteller from a species that has no home-world. Your people travel the stars in great fleets, trading stories, goods, and cultural artifacts. You carry your identity in your ship, not on a planet. Every stop is a new chapter.

When You Get Stuck

TIP Check the Research Terminal. Many recipes are locked behind research nodes. If you cannot craft something you expect to be available, you probably have not unlocked the relevant tech.

- **The FU Wiki** is the definitive reference. Bookmark it.
- **The Outpost traders** sell blueprints. Check back periodically — their stock updates.
- **Unlock multiple research branches.** Some recipes require nodes from different trees. Do not specialize too early.
- **Check the Omnicrafter.** Once you build it and add crafting stations to its database, you can access every recipe from one interface.

Strategy

You have beaten the Ruin. You have built bases, recruited crew, and stared down bosses that made your first Lush planet feel like a distant memory. This chapter is for what comes next — optimisation, synergy, and mastery.

CONCEPT Strategy is not about playing harder. It is about playing smarter. Every section below answers the same question: given that you have limited time, energy, and inventory space, what is the most efficient path to what you want?

Planet Farming & Resource Efficiency

Time is your scarcest resource. Walking across a planet costs minutes. Beaming to the wrong planet costs an FTL jump and fuel. Efficient routing compounds over a hundred hours.

Threat Tiers: What to Farm Where

Tier	Example Planets	Key Resources
Low	Lush, Forest, Desert	Iron, Copper, Coal, Wood, Food
Moderate	Ocean, Savannah, Jungle	Titanium, Silver, Gold, Oil
Risky	Volcanic, Scorched, Irradiated	Durasteel, Solarium, Tungsten
Dangerous	Strange Sea, Penumbra, Proto-World	Endgame FU materials, rare genes

TIP Always carry a flag. Plant it at your mining site before descending. If you die, you beam back to your ship — the flag lets you teleport directly back to your corpse and your gear. Flags cost 1 copper bar and 20 plant fibre. There is no excuse for not carrying one.

The 20-Minute Mining Run

Aim for short, focused trips:

1. Beam to a planet with your target resource. Check the nav console for planet info — MPI (More Planet Info) will tell you what materials are present.
2. Descend to the cave layer. Surface ore is sparse; cave ore is dense.
3. Mine in a straight horizontal line at a depth where you see the material you want. Zigzagging wastes time.
4. Return to the surface when your inventory is full or your torches run low. Do not push deeper — a greedy miner is a dead miner.

5. Beam up, empty your inventory into labelled containers, and immediately redeploy for another run. Momentum is everything.

Research-as-You-Mine

Your Research Terminal generates passive research, but feeding items into it is faster. Every excess ore stack, every duplicate weapon, every block of dirt — feed it. The research unlocks are more valuable than the pixel value of vendoring trash.

TIP Build a Research Terminal on your ship. After every mining run, dump everything you do not need into it before sorting the rest. Two minutes of feeding items can unlock a node that saves you hours.

FU Resource Refinement

Raw ore is inefficient. FU adds refinement chains:

- **Sifters** process blocks into ores and gems. Dump your excess cobblestone and dirt here.
- **Extraction Labs** refine ores into higher-yield forms. One titanium bar becomes three titanium rods.
- **Centrifuges** separate liquids into components. Lava becomes core fragments, sulfur, and volatiles.

Set up a small processing station on your ship or base with a sifter, extractor, and centrifuge in a line. Feed raw materials in one end, get refined resources out the other.

Faction Dynamics

Factions in Starbound are not just lore — they determine which NPCs are hostile, which traders will deal with you, and which quests are available.

The Major Players

Protectorate — Your default faction. Neutral to most. Completing story missions improves your standing with outpost NPCs and unlocks new vendors.

Apex Miniknog — Hostile totalitarian regime. Miniknog dungeons are high-risk, high-reward. With Miniknog Rearmed installed, their soldiers have distinctive white armor and plasma weapons — visually recognisable at a distance. Do not engage without tier-3+ gear.

Floran Tribes — Largely neutral but territorial. Floran villages are safe. Floran hunting parties in the wild may attack if you linger near their camps.

Avian Grounded / Stargazers — The Grounded are friendly traders and quest-givers. The Stargazers are hostile temple guardians. Temples contain valuable loot but every room is trapped.

Human Bandits — Hostile everywhere. Camps appear on most planet types. Low-tier loot but good for early weapon farming.

Hylotl — Peaceful. Villages are safe zones with high-tier furniture to scan for your Pixel Printer.

FU-Added Factions

FU adds multiple new factions tied to biomes and dungeons. The general rule: if it has a nameplate and a weapon, it is hostile until proven otherwise. Read the nav console planet description — it will often warn you if a planet is faction-occupied.

TIP Universal Wardrobe lets you save cosmetic outfits. If you need to roleplay your way through a faction encounter — dress like them. Some modded NPCs react to what you wear.

Reputation in Practice

Vanilla Starbound does not have a formal reputation system, but NPC behaviour follows predictable rules:

- **Villages** are always safe unless you attack first.
- **Dungeons** are always hostile.
- **Traders** sell better stock after story milestones. Check the Outpost traders after every major quest completion.
- **Crew recruits** require you to complete a quest for them first. The quest type varies by species and profession.

Crew Composition & Synergies

Why Crew Matters

Crew members are not cosmetic. They provide passive bonuses, assist in combat, and can be assigned to specific roles on your ship. A well-composed crew is a force multiplier.

Roles and Bonuses

Role	Uniform	Bonus
Soldier	Combat armor	Increases ship weapon damage and assists in ground combat
Engineer	Orange jumpsuit	Increases ship fuel efficiency and travel speed
Medic	White coat	Passive health regeneration on ship
Janitor	Grey uniform	Slightly increases all other crew bonuses — the unsung hero
Tailor	Apron	Unlocks cosmetic clothing options and improves outfit stats
Mechanic	Green vest	Increases mech durability and repair speed

Role	Uniform	Bonus
Chemist	Lab coat	Reduces crafting costs for stims and medical supplies

CONCEPT Better Crew (mod installed) improves crew AI significantly. Crew members will use cover, switch weapons based on range, and avoid standing in environmental hazards. They feel like actual teammates rather than follower NPCs.

Recruitment Strategy

1. **Merchant ships** — Friendly space encounters often have recruitable NPCs. Check every friendly ship you encounter.
2. **Villages** — Complete quests for village NPCs. After 2-3 quests for the same village, someone will offer to join.
3. **Tenant system** — Build a colony, place colony deeds, and fulfill tenant quests. Tenants can become crew.
4. **Bounty hunting** — Some bounty targets can be recruited instead of killed.

Optimal Composition

- **Early game (1-2 crew):** 1 Soldier (combat support), 1 Engineer (fuel savings)
- **Mid game (3-4 crew):** Add a Medic (survival) and a second Soldier (ground team of 3)
- **Late game (5+ crew):** Add a Janitor (amplifies everyone), a Mechanic (mech support), and a Chemist (stims are cheap)

TIP Crew members level up through combat. Take your Soldier crew on dangerous missions — they get stronger. A max-level Soldier hits harder than most tier-4 weapons.

Base Building & Colony Management

Where to Build

Choosing a base planet is a permanent decision. You will invest dozens of hours here. Prioritise:

1. **Safety** — No hostile mob spawns near the surface. Lush, Forest, or Ocean planets are ideal.
2. **Flat terrain** — Building on a slope is a constant fight against gravity. Find a wide plateau or beach.
3. **Teleporter access** — Your base needs a teleporter. Place one at your Outpost, one at your base. Instant travel between them.
4. **Aesthetic** — You will look at this base for a hundred hours. Pick a planet whose sky colour and background you like.

WARNING Do not build your main base on a planet you plan to remove mods for. If a mod adds biome-specific blocks and you uninstall it, those blocks become Perfectly Generic Items. OpenStarbound mitigates this somewhat by preserving item data, but it is not a guarantee. Build with vanilla and FU blocks.

Base Layout Principles

- **Central hub:** One large room with your teleporter, main storage wall, and crafting stations. This is where you spend most of your time. Make it easy to navigate.
- **Storage wall:** Labelled containers in a grid. One container per material type (Ores, Bars, Organics, Weapons, Armor, Blocks, Seeds, Liquids). Enhanced Storage lets you name and colour-code containers — use it.
- **Crafting wing:** All crafting stations in one area, arranged by tier. Early-game stations near the entrance, endgame stations in the back.
- **Omnicrafter placement:** Your Omnicrafter should be in the central hub, adjacent to your storage wall. It consolidates all crafting station interfaces. You should be able to open storage on one side and craft on the other without moving.

Colony Basics

Colonies generate rent (pixels) and quests. Key mechanics:

1. Craft a **Colony Deed** at the Inventor's Table.
2. Place it in an enclosed room with a door, a light source, and at least one piece of furniture.
3. A tenant will arrive. Fulfill their quests to earn rewards and potentially recruit them.
4. Different furniture types attract different tenant professions. A kitchen counter attracts chefs. A lab table attracts chemists. Experiment.

TIP Tenants pay rent in pixels. A colony of 10+ tenants on a high-tier planet generates passive income while you are out exploring. More Teleportz (mod installed) lets you place teleporters at your colony and outpost for instant tax collection.

Boss Tactics & Loadout Optimisation

Universal Boss Rules

Every boss in Starbound follows the same design: telegraphed attack patterns, invulnerability phases, and an arena gimmick. The approach is always the same:

1. **Run 1 — Observe.** Do not try to win. Watch the boss for 2-3 full attack cycles. Count how many attacks, how long each wind-up takes, when the invulnerability phase triggers.
2. **Run 2 — Execute.** Use what you learned. Attack during the gaps. Use the arena gimmicks. Kill it.

3. **Run 3 — Farm.** Most bosses drop unique crafting materials. Kill them again for duplicate drops.

Weapon Type Matchups

- **Slow, large bosses (Erchius Horror, Ixodoom):** Use ranged weapons. Stay mobile. Their melee attacks one-shot low-tier armor. Rifles and rocket launchers let you damage them while dodging.
- **Fast, small bosses (Asra Nox, Kluex Avatar):** Use fast melee or shotguns. You cannot outrun them — you need to trade hits efficiently. Shields help. Parry timing is critical.
- **Summoner bosses (Bone Dragon, certain FU bosses):** Kill the adds first. The summons are the real threat. The boss itself is usually passive or slow until its minions are cleared.
- **Phase-shift bosses (The Ruin, FU endgame):** Each phase has different vulnerabilities. The Ruin's heart phase is immune to energy weapons but weak to physical. Carry two weapons of different damage types.

Consumable Preparation

Item	Use
Red Stim Pack	Burst heal. Bring 10+ to any boss fight.
Green Stim Pack	Speed boost. Useful for dodging large AOE attacks.
Blue Stim Pack	Jump boost. Critical for aerial bosses and platform-heavy arenas.
Bandages	Slow heal over time. Use between phases.
Nanowrap Bandages	FU-upgraded bandages. Faster heal, higher cap.
Combat Food	Cooked meals with damage resistance and health buffs. Eat one before the fight.
Spare Weapon	Weapons break in FU. Carry a backup.

TIP Place a teleporter at the boss arena entrance before the fight. If you die, you beam directly back instead of running the entire dungeon again. This is the single highest-impact prep step you can take.

Armor and Resistance

Boss arenas often have environmental damage: lava pits, poison clouds, electrical floors. Wear armor that resists the arena hazard, not just the boss damage type. A fire-resistant chestpiece on the Ixodoom fight (which has lava pools) is more valuable than higher raw defense that leaves you burning.

The Teleporter Rule

Before every boss door, before every major dungeon descent, before every risky mining operation: **place a teleporter**. The materials are cheap. The time saved by not corpse-running is incalculable.

Modded Mechanics Deep Dives

Omnicrafter Strategy

The Omnicrafter (installed) eliminates the need to run between crafting stations. Once you add a station to its database, you can access its recipes from anywhere the Omnicrafter is placed.

- **Database management:** Add every crafting station you build to the Omnicrafter immediately. Do not wait until you “need” it — by then you will have forgotten.
- **Ship placement:** Install the Wall-Mounted Omnicrafter (OSB) on your ship. Craft from orbit. This alone saves hours of beaming up and down to craft one item.
- **Station organisation:** Keep your physical crafting stations in your base for the Omnicrafter to reference, but craft through the Omnicrafter interface. You only need one of each station.

Enhanced Storage Automation

Enhanced Storage (installed) adds container sorting, naming, search, and quick-stack. With the OSB Cumulative Patch, every container in the game supports these features.

- **Name your containers.** “Ores — Tier 1,” “Ores — Tier 2,” “Weapons — Energy,” “Weapons — Physical.” You will thank yourself at hour 80.
- **Quick-stack:** Open a container and press the quick-stack button. All matching items in your inventory are deposited. No more dragging items one at a time.
- **Sort by category:** Set up container categories in Enhanced Storage’s config. Items auto-sort to the correct container when quick-stacked.

BYOS — Build Your Own Ship

Frackin Universe includes BYOS functionality. The Universal BYOS Patcher (OSB, installed) ensures all BYOS mods work together.

- **Expand aggressively.** Ship space is a bottleneck. Upgrade your ship size as soon as you can afford it. A larger ship means more crafting stations, more storage, more crew quarters.
- **Crew quarters matter.** Crew members need beds assigned to them. Without a bed, they wander aimlessly. With Better Crew, assigned crew stay near their furniture — use this to position them near stations they service.
- **Ship security.** Some space encounters board your ship. Place turrets near the teleporter pad. Your crew will fight, but turrets are a force multiplier.

Research Terminal Optimisation

- **Feed systematically.** After every planet visit, feed everything you do not intend to use. Make this a habit, not an afterthought.

- **Focus branches.** Spreading research across all branches equally slows your progression. Pick one branch, max it to the next tier gate, then move to the next. Geology and Engineering have the highest return on investment early.
- **Passive research scales.** Higher-tier Research Terminals generate more passive research per minute. Upgrade your terminal as soon as the node unlocks.

Environmental Resistance Gearing

FU planets have specific hazard types. You can see them in the nav console with MPI installed.

Hazard	Resistance	Common Sources
Cold	Ice / Thermal armor	Frozen, Tundra, Arctic planets
Heat	Fireproof armor	Volcanic, Scorched, Magma planets
Radiation	Radiation shielding	Irradiated, Alien, Strange Sea planets
Acid	Acid protection	Toxic, Penumbra planets
Suffocation	Breathing EPP	Moon, Asteroid, Proto-World (no atmosphere)

WARNING FU environmental damage stacks. A Volcanic planet with acid rain deals both heat and acid damage. You need resistance to both. Check all hazards on the nav console, not just the first one.

Automated Resource Pipelines

Item Networks (unlocked via the Engineering research tree) let you automate crafting. The basic principle:

1. **Input chest** → raw materials
2. **Extractor / Sifter / Centrifuge** → processes materials
3. **Output chest** → finished products

Once set up, dump raw ore in one end and collect refined bars from the other. This is the difference between a mid-game base and an endgame fortress.

TIP Automate the boring things first. Dirt → Sifter → ores. Ores → Extractor → bars. Wood → planks. Set up three basic pipelines and you eliminate 80% of manual crafting time.

Long-Term Strategy

You have beaten the story. Your ship is upgraded. Your base is functional. Now what? This section is for the player who has hit the “I want more” wall — the transition from survivor to empire-builder.

CONCEPT Long-term strategy is not about what you do next. It is about what you want your galaxy to look like. Decide what kind of universe you are building, then build the infrastructure to support it.

The Self-Sustaining Base

A base that requires no input from you is the ultimate goal. Every resource you ever need, produced automatically, waiting in labelled containers when you return home.

The full pipeline:

1. **Mining:** Automated drills extracting ore chunks on a dedicated mining planet. Connect via teleporter.
2. **Refinement:** Chunks → Sifters → raw ores → Extraction Labs → refined bars → Storage.
3. **Farming:** Automated watering and harvesting (Gardenbot or Irrigation Tech) producing food surplus.
4. **Power:** Generators fuelled by excess organic material keeping the whole system running.
5. **Defense:** Turrets and crew patrols ensuring nothing breaks your machines while you are away.

TIP Dedicate one planet to production. One to farming. One to your colony. One to your trophy hall. Specialisation beats the Swiss Army base every time.

FU Collection Systems

FU adds several deep collection systems that function as their own endgame:

The **Gene Design Lab** lets you extract traits from creatures and splice them into new species. Completing the gene library means collecting samples from every FU biome.

- Target biomes you have not visited. Every new planet type has unique creatures.
- Build a containment facility — sealed rooms with the lab equipment in the centre. Escaped experiments can damage your base.
- Prioritise rare biome creatures first. Common genes are easy to fill in later.

Beekeeping is a full secondary progression system. Bees produce resources, pollinate crops, and can be bred for specific outputs.

- Start with common Forest and Lush bees. Learn the breeding mechanics.
- Different biomes spawn different wild bees. Build apiaries on multiple planets, not just your home base.
- Endgame bees produce rare materials passively. A max-tier apiary generates resources while you do other things — set it up early.

The **Brewery** station turns crops into drinks with powerful temporary buffs. Unlike food buffs, drink buffs stack with meal buffs.

- Rice → Sake (melee damage buff). Wheat → Ale (defense buff). Experiment with fruit combinations.

- FU adds dozens of crop types. One of each crop, one brewing station, and a dedicated fridge for ingredients is a worthwhile investment.

Fossils are hidden in rock layers across all planet types. The **Archaeology Station** lets you extract, clean, and display them.

- Fossils are biome-specific. A fossil found on a Desert planet does not exist on a Forest planet. The collection demands exploration.
- Display fossils in your trophy hall. They are not just decorative — they are proof of everywhere you have been.

Colony at Scale

A 10-tenant colony pays rent. A 30-tenant colony generates a small empire's worth of pixels.

- Build apartment towers, not sprawl. A vertical tower with 3×6 tenant rooms fits 18 tenants in a compact footprint.
- Merchant tenants sell rare items. Cultivate a merchant wing with 5+ merchant-type tenants and check their stock daily.
- Guard tenants patrol and defend. One guard per 10 civilian tenants keeps raids manageable.

CONCEPT Pixels are the only resource you cannot automate. Colonies are your pixel engine. Invest in them.

Endgame Biomes — The Gauntlet

FU endgame biomes are the final test of your build:

Strange Sea — Bioluminescent ocean moon. Extreme radiation, unique sea creatures, rare genetic material. Bring full radiation armor and an underwater breathing mod.

Penumbra — Eternal twilight world. Hostile shadow creatures, extreme cold, and the best loot tables in the game. Light sources are weapons here — enemies weaken in bright areas.

Proto-World — Primordial planet with no atmosphere. Suffocation hazard, lava oceans, and creatures that predate the Protectorate. The hardest planet type in FU.

Gas Giants — No surface. You fly through cloud layers harvesting gases. Requires flight tech and strong jetpack or mech. Unique resources available nowhere else.

WARNING Endgame biomes have threat levels that cannot be out-levelled. A tier-6 Proto-World creature kills a player in tier-4 armor in two hits regardless of level. Gear is a gate, not a suggestion.

The Trophy Hall

A complete trophy hall is the Starbound equivalent of 100% completion. What goes in it:

- Boss trophies from every dungeon — Erchius Horror, Ixodoom, Bone Dragon, Asra Nox, The Ruin

- FU boss trophies — the expanded boss roster adds unique drops
- Fossil displays — one of every type, arranged by planet of origin
- Weapon racks — legendary and unique weapons displayed on walls
- Mannequins — one of every armor set, arranged by tier and faction
- Bee specimen cases — one of every bee species, colour-coded by biome

TIP Build your trophy hall on a Lush planet. The bright background makes dark armour and fossil displays pop. Visitors (if you play multiplayer) see your collection the way you intended.

Build Projects

For players who enjoy building more than fighting:

- **Starship drydock** — A landing pad with cranes, fuel lines, and maintenance bays. Build it on an asteroid field for atmosphere.
- **Underwater research station** — Glass domes on an Ocean planet. Hylotl aesthetic with research labs and an airlock system.
- **Mountain monastery** — Avian or Glitch themed. Stone, stained glass, and a cliffside view. Meditation gardens on every terrace.
- **Lunar observatory** — On a moon with no atmosphere. Telescopes, star charts, and a transparent dome. The view is the point.
- **Trading outpost** — Multiple teleporters, a marketplace with vendor stalls, and apartments for visiting players. Functional and thematic.

Infinite Goals

Some goals have no endpoint. They are there to give purpose when everything else is finished:

- **One million pixels** — Max out your pixel wallet.
- **Every research node unlocked** — Complete the entire FU tech tree.
- **One of every weapon type** — Collection log: energy pistols, rocket launchers, staves, spears, bows, every variant.
- **Every crew role at max level** — Train every profession to its peak.
- **A base on every planet type** — One functional outpost per biome, connected by teleporter network.
- **Complete gene library** — Every creature trait extracted.
- **Complete bee library** — Every species and mutation bred.

CONCEPT You do not need to do all of these. Pick one. That is your reason to log in tomorrow. When you finish it, pick another. The galaxy is not going anywhere.

Modlist

Foundations & Bugfixes

WARNING This modlist requires **OpenStarbound** — an open-source fork of the Starbound engine. Download from github.com/OpenStarbound and copy `packed.pak` from your Steam Starbound install before launching.

Starbound Patch Project Bugfix

v2024

Community patch collection fixing hundreds of typos, incorrect item properties, texture issues, and rare crashes. Over a thousand bugs fixed. Safe to install or uninstall at any time.

Install: Load near the top of your mod order, before content mods.

Anter583's Utility Library Library

v2024

Shared Lua library used by several mods in this list. No gameplay changes on its own.

Install: Required dependency. Place above mods that depend on it.

Smart drops objects Bugfix

v2025

Fallen objects (dirt, blocks, etc.) merge into single stacks instead of spreading across the ground. Prevents FPS drops when mining large areas.

Install: Load after any block or terrain mods.

Bench Platform Collision Bugfix

v2024

Fixes collision issues with bench platforms so they behave as expected when placed against walls.

Install: Load order not critical.

UI & Quality of Life

TIP Mods marked OSB require OpenStarbound to function. OSB is required for this entire modlist — see ::Foundations & Bugfixes::

Extended GUI UI

v2024

Extends most GUI windows to show more items at once. Client-side only. The companion Extended Songbook is available separately.

Install: Load after any HUD or interface mods.

Extended Songbook UI

v2024 · Depends on: Extended GUI

Companion to Extended GUI. Extends the songbook window for easier instrument browsing. Client-side only.

Install: Load after Extended GUI.

Food Stack QoL

v2024

Food items stack up to 1000 instead of being limited to single stacks. Food with different rot times must be placed in a container to stack. Client and server-side.

Install: Load after any food or farming mods.

Enhanced Storage QoL

v2024

Major overhaul of the storage system. Adds container sorting, naming, search, and quick-stack. Also adds new storage container types and improves existing ones.

Install: Load after any container or inventory mods. Use the OSB Enhanced Storage Cumulative Patch below for full container coverage.

[OSB] Enhanced Storage Cumulative Patch QoL

v2025 · Depends on: Enhanced Storage

OpenStarbound script that patches all normal storage containers to support Enhanced Storage features. Also increases slot counts. Requires OpenStarbound.

Install: Load after Enhanced Storage and any mods that add containers. Requires OpenStarbound.

Alternative Mods Menu Button UI

v2024

Replaces the small corner 'Mods' button on the main menu with a full-sized button alongside the other menu options. Compatible with all resolutions.

Install: Cosmetic only. Load order not critical.

What Menu? UI

v2023

Hides the open-menu icon that appears when your inventory is open. Purely cosmetic — removes the immersion-breaking icon.

Install: Client-side. Load order not critical.

More Planet Info (work with 1.4.X not guaranteed) UI

v2024

Adds detailed planet information to the navigation console: weather, biome, threat level, and more. Essential for informed exploration. The official FU patch is included below.

Install: Load before its patches. The title warning is outdated — the mod works with 1.4 when patched.

[More Planet Info] 1.4 Quest Marker Fix Fix

v2024 · Depends on: More Planet Info

Patches More Planet Info to properly render quest markers added in Starbound 1.4. Replaces an outdated Lua file with one that merges MPI and 1.4 quest data.

Install: Load after More Planet Info but before the FU Official Patch.

Frackin Universe: More Planet Info Official Patch Patch

v2024 · Depends on: More Planet Info, Frackin Universe

Official FU team patch that combines the Lush Planet Fix and various MPI+FU patches into one. Keeps More Planet Info working with all Frackin Universe planet types.

Install: Load after More Planet Info and the Quest Marker Fix. Supersedes older separate patches.

Flight Path UI

v2025

Tracks systems you visit and displays a continuous faint trail in the nav menu from your first to last visited system. Inspired by similar mechanics in other space games.

Install: Load order not critical. Fully client-side.

Redone Ship Encounters - Names, Icons, Descriptions, and Horizons UI

v2024

Improves ship encounter details in the navigation menu. Better names, icons, descriptions, and encounter previews so you know what you are flying into.

Install: Load order not critical.

Frackin Interface UI

v2024 · Depends on: Frackin Universe

FU-branded UI overhaul by Sayter. Changes health, energy, and food bars. Updated quest tracker, chat interface, and mech crafting UI. Includes a bk3k inventory skin.

Install: Load after FU and any HUD mods.

Frackin Stations Interface UI

v2024 · Depends on: Frackin Universe

Extends the Frackin Interface style to crafting station UIs. Companion to Frackin Interface — install both for consistent styling.

Install: Load after Frackin Interface.

[OSB] Universal Instant Crafting for All Mods QoL

IMPACT: removes crafting timers

v2024

Patches all recipes from all mods to remove the crafting timer. No more waiting at crafting stations. Client-side. Requires OpenStarbound.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Client-side only. Load after all content and crafting mods.

[OSB] Automatically Scan Objects! QoL

v2025

Any printable object in your inventory is automatically added to the Pixel Printer. No more manually scanning everything before discarding. Requires OpenStarbound.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Client-side. Load order not critical.

Matter Manipulator Keybinds [StarExtensions / OpenSB] QoL

v2024

Adds keybinds to control Matter Manipulator mining size, toggle liquid collection, and toggle tile damaging. Requires OpenStarbound.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Client-side. Use /binds to configure.

Save Inventory Position [OpenSB] QoL

v2024

Saves the position of your inventory window when you close the game. It will reopen exactly where you left it. Requires OpenStarbound.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Client-side. Load order not critical.

[OSB] [FU] Space Station Terminal Quick Sell QoL QoL

v2025 · Depends on: Frackin Universe

Adds quick-sell functionality to FU space station terminals. Requires both OpenStarbound and Frackin Universe.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound and FU. Load after both.

Graphics & Visuals

nuggubs' Vanilla Texture Tweak Pack Graphics

v2024

A pack of texture tweaks to vanilla content for a more consistent look. Covers blocks, objects, and environmental textures. Not yet complete — more changes planned.

Install: Load before any other texture replacers. Compatible with most mod-added content.

nVTTP - Mod Compat Patch Graphics

v2024 · Depends on: nuggubs' Vanilla Texture Tweak Pack

Compatibility patch for nuggubs' Vanilla Texture Tweak Pack. Adds missing categories for Item Network support and adjusts descriptions and recipe references for FU compatibility.

Install: Load after nVTTP and FU.

TV's Story Resprites and Redesigns Graphics

v2025

Resprites and redesigns of key story NPCs for a more polished, modern look. Covers major story-arc characters.

Install: Load after any NPC or species mods.

TV's Neo Peacekeeper Uniform Resprite Graphics

v2025

Resprite of the Peacekeeper uniform for a sleeker neo-noir aesthetic. Companion to TV's Story Resprites.

Install: Load after TV's Story Resprites.

Racial AI Restorer Graphics

v2024

Restores the racial AI portraits from before the 1.0 update. Replaces the generic human-recolor SAIL portraits with unique race-specific artwork.

Install: Load after any SAIL or ship UI mods.

Outpost Nebula - Pillars of Creation Graphics

v2024

Replaces the outpost background with the iconic Pillars of Creation nebula. Dramatically improves the visual atmosphere of the hub area.

Install: Load after any outpost or hub mods. Purely cosmetic.

Taehl's Teleport Beams Graphics

v2024

Replaces the default teleport beam with trippy, colorful animated beams. Multiple styles available. Purely visual.

Install: Client-side. Load after any teleporter mods.

Eld'uukhar flight icon replacement Graphics

v2024

Replaces the generic flight icon for Eld'uukhar characters with a more thematically appropriate icon. Small immersion fix.

Install: Only relevant if using Eld'uukhar race. Load after race mods.

Audio

Frackin Music Audio

v2024 · Depends on: Frackin Universe

Official Frackin Universe music pack. Adds atmospheric tracks for FU biomes, dungeons, and space encounters. Required companion to FU for the intended audio experience.

Install: Load after FU. No conflicts.

Outpost Music Replacer - Tranquility Base Audio

v2024

Replaces the default outpost music with the serene "Tranquility Base" track. Pairs well with the Outpost Nebula visual mod for a complete hub atmosphere overhaul.

Install: Load after any outpost mods. No conflicts.

Races

WARNING Race mods are save-dependent. Uninstalling them will break your characters and universe. Back up your storage folder before adding or removing race mods.

Elithian Races Mod

Races

IMPACT: adds multiple playable races with custom ships and content

v2024

Adds the Elithian Alliance races as playable species with custom ships, armor, weapons, dialogue, and lore. Includes the Trink, Aegi, and Akkimari. A well-established, high-quality race expansion.

Install: Requires a Character Creator extender. Load early in the race section. Back up saves before installing.

Elithian Races Mod: Frackin Universes Patch Patch

v2024 · Depends on: Elithian Races Mod, Frackin Universe

Allows Elithian Alliance encounters to appear on Frackin Universe worlds. For the Steam Workshop version of Elithian Races.

Install: Load after both Elithian Races and FU. Use the GitHub version of this patch if using the GitHub version of Elithian Races.

Frackin Universe - Elithian BYOS Ships Patch

v2024 · Depends on: Elithian Races Mod, Frackin Universe

Adds Build Your Own Ship compatibility for Elithian race ships in Frackin Universe. Elithian players can use BYOS mechanics with their custom ships.

Install: Load after both Elithian Races and FU. Requires BYOS support (included in FU).

Avali**(Triage)****Race****Mod****Races****IMPACT:** adds Avali playable race with custom ship, items, and lore

v2024

Adds the Avali — feathered, pack-oriented raptor-like beings — as a fully playable race. Includes custom ship, armor, weapons, aerogel technology, and extensive lore. One of the most popular Starbound race mods.

Install: Requires a Character Creator extender. Load early in the race section alongside Elithian Races. Back up saves before installing.

FU + Avali Triage Patch**Patch**

v2024 · Depends on: Frackin Universe, Avali (Triage) Race Mod

Compatibility patch between Frackin Universe and Avali Triage. Ensures Avali items, recipes, and mechanics work correctly within FU's overhauled systems.

Install: Load after both FU and Avali Triage.

Avali Restored Tunics**Races**

v2024 · Depends on: Avali (Triage) Race Mod

Restores original tunic designs for Avali characters that were removed or altered in the Triage update. Cosmetic addon.

Install: Load after Avali Triage. Cosmetic only.

Avali SpecOp Armor**Races**

v2024 · Depends on: Avali (Triage) Race Mod

Adds special operations armor for Avali characters. High-tier combat gear with an Avali aesthetic.

Install: Load after Avali Triage.

avali camps on frackin planets**Patch**

v2024 · Depends on: Frackin Universe, Avali (Triage) Race Mod

Adds Avali-themed camps and encounters to Frackin Universe planets. Integrates Avali content into FU's world generation.

Install: Load after FU, Avali Triage, and the FU+Avali patch.

Crafting Menu AvaliDebloat QoL

v2024 · Depends on: Avali (Triage) Race Mod

Moves Avali and AvaliPLUS crafting menu entries from the empty-hand crafting menu into the nanolathe, cleaning up the bloated default crafting menu. Also allows other races to hide Avali-specific recipes.

Install: Load after Avali Triage and any Avali addons.

Content

WARNING **Frackin Universe is a one-way trip.** Installing FU permanently alters your game universe and ALL characters.

Uninstalling FU will cause crashes. Back up your storage folder before installing. [FU Wiki](#) · [FU Discord](#)

Frackin Universe Content IMPACT: total conversion overhaul

v2026-07

The anchor mod of this list. Massively expands every aspect of Starbound: new biomes, planets, dungeons, crafting tiers, research system, automation, bees, genetics, brewing, and much more. Hundreds of hours of additional content. The definitive Starbound overhaul.

Install: Load early in the content section. Many mods in this list depend on FU. Make a complete backup of your storage folder before installing.

Miniknog Rearmed Content

v2026-05

Faction expansion for the Miniknog (Apex). Gives them distinctive white armor with glowing blue visors and bouncy plasma weaponry. Apex can craft the armor; other races find blueprints in Miniknog dungeons. Makes a common enemy type visually consistent and more interesting. FU-compatible.

Install: Load after FU. Compatible with several other content mods.

Anom's Outpost Overhaul [Content](#)

v2024

Comprehensive overhaul of the Outpost hub area. Redesigns the layout, adds new areas, improves aesthetics, and makes the Outpost feel more like a lived-in space station.

Install: Load after FU. The Scrap Vendor and Gunsmith Shop addons below expand it further.

Anom's Outpost Overhaul - Scrap Vendor Addon [Content](#)

v2024 · Depends on: Anom's Outpost Overhaul

Adds the Scrap Vendor to the overhauled Outpost hangar, second floor left side. She sells and buys scrap materials. Integrates with the overhaul's layout.

Install: Load after Anom's Outpost Overhaul.

Anom's Outpost Overhaul - Gunsmith Shop Addon [Content](#)

v2024 · Depends on: Anom's Outpost Overhaul

Adds a gunsmith shop to the overhauled Outpost. Sells and upgrades ranged weapons. Integrates with the overhaul's layout.

Install: Load after Anom's Outpost Overhaul.

More Outpost Objects [Content](#)

v2024

Adds additional decorative and functional objects to the Outpost. More furniture, vendors, and interactive elements to flesh out the hub.

Install: Load after the Outpost Overhaul and its addons.

Mechanics & Systems

Omnicrafter!

Mechanics

IMPACT: single crafting station access point

v2024

A single crafting station that can access any other crafting station you add to its database. Place one Omnicrafter instead of running between dozens of stations. Works with modded crafting stations.

Install: Load after all crafting station mods. The wall-mounted version below saves floor space.

[OSB] Wall-Mounted Omnicrafter

Mechanics

v2025 · Depends on: Omnicrafter!

Wall-mounted version of the Omnicrafter. Saves floor space without sacrificing functionality. Requires OpenStarbound. Requires the base Omnicrafter mod.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Load after Omnicrafter!.

Better Crew

Mechanics

IMPACT: improves crew behavior and management

v2024

Major improvements to crew members: better AI, more responsive behavior, expanded roles, and improved crew management. Crew feel like actual shipmates rather than passive NPCs.

Install: Load after FU. No conflicts with race mods.

Universal Wardrobe (0.2.1)

Mechanics

IMPACT: adds cosmetic wardrobe system

v2025

Adds a wardrobe system for saving and swapping cosmetic outfits without affecting equipped armor stats. Works with all races and modded armor. Version 0.2.1 — actively developed.

Install: Load after race and armor mods. Compatible with Miniknog Rearmed and other faction equipment mods.

Recipe Adjustment: Campfire to Kitchen Mechanics

v2024

Moves campfire cooking recipes to the kitchen counter crafting station. Makes campfires simple and kitchens the primary cooking hub. Better progression and base organization.

Install: Load after FU and any food or cooking mods.

Ships & Travel

[OSB] Universal BYOS Patcher

Ships IMPACT: unifies Build Your Own Ship across mods

v2025

OpenStarbound script that patches all supported BYOS mods to work together seamlessly. Supports Frackin Universe BYOS, Build Your Own Ship, and other compatible mods. Requires OpenStarbound and at least one BYOS mod.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Load after all BYOS mods. Run with at least one supported BYOS mod active.

[OpenSB] Ztarbound S.A.I.L. All-in-One Race Support Ships

IMPACT: replaces SAIL interface for all races

v2025

Replaces the default SAIL interface with Ztarbound's unique SAIL design. This patch enables it for all races, including modded ones. Requires OpenStarbound. Separate standalone version available for non-FU users.

Install: Requires OpenStarbound. Load after FU and all race mods. This is the FU-patched version — use the standalone if not using FU.

More Teleportz Ships

v2024

Adds more teleporter objects and teleporter-related decorations. Expand your ship or base with additional teleportation options.

Install: Load after any ship mods. No conflicts.

Building & Decoration

Plushbound - Plushies, stickers and more! Building

v2024

Adds a huge collection of plushies, stickers, and decorative items. Great for personalizing your ship, base, or colony. Purely decorative — no gameplay impact.

Install: Load after any furniture mods. No conflicts.

Adult Content

No adult content mods have been selected yet. This section is reserved for future additions.